CASE STUDY · PRODUCT MANAGER

Denner AG

Adapting the Denner offer to French-speaking Switzerland for better commercial performance

HEAD OFFICE	ROLE	PERIOD
Grubenstrasse 10, Zurich	Product manager	2020 – 2023

CUSTOMER INSIGHT · RANGE · PROMOTIONS · MOVING UPMARKET

100+
UNSUITABLE PRODUCTS DELISTED AND REPLACED

1,000+
PROMOTIONS LAUNCHED

No. 1
BEST-PERFORMING REGION IN THE COUNTRY

THE CHALLENGE

At Denner, a subsidiary of the Migros group, marketing and purchasing decisions had historically been centralised in Zurich, with mostly German-speaking staff. This approach showed its limits in French-speaking Switzerland, where some products that were popular in German-speaking Switzerland sold far less.

The offer did not reflect the cultural and food preferences of French-speaking consumers, which hurt store performance in the region.

THE SOLUTION

As product manager responsible for the Food sector in French-speaking Switzerland, I took the initiative to design a concept specific to the region, to better meet local consumers' expectations.

I set up a direct dialogue with French-speaking customers to understand their food preferences and brand expectations, then adapted the product offer accordingly.

THE RESULT

Within three years, I had delisted more than 100 products unsuited to the French-speaking market and replaced them with better-targeted, better-performing items in line with local customers' needs. This improved sales in French-speaking Switzerland and made use of the awareness of French brands, which served as free communication leverage.

Under my direction, more than 1,000 promotions were launched, and French-speaking Switzerland became Denner's best-performing region in the country. The chain moved upmarket in quality, reducing its share of hard-discount products in favour of a more premium offer. This transformation led to double-digit annual growth in fresh products, reconciled the Denner brand with French-speaking consumers and strengthened their loyalty.

TODAY

Following these results, Migros decided to adopt this regional model by hiring product managers dedicated to each region, alongside the existing category managers. The project enabled Denner to better meet local expectations and improve its competitiveness across Switzerland.

Does your offer really speak to your French-speaking clients?

A 30-minute call to identify the decision that matters most to you. No commitment.

BOOK A CALL